

What 1,000 Real Startups Reveal About Revenue, Positioning & Growth

An evidence-based read on performance, market positioning, and acquisition efficiency — notes for sharpening how I think about budget, pricing, and targeting.

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

1,000

startups analyzed across 18+ categories

\$334M

total revenue mapped across the set

61%

of all revenue sits with just the top 10 startups

0.23

correlation between follower count and revenue — nearly none

Three Questions This Analysis Answers

Each section below distills two slides of analysis into one clear, self-contained read — no extra context needed beyond what's on the slide.

01

Business Performance

Slides 3–4

Which categories actually earn — and is the market concentrated in a handful of winners?

02

Market & Product Positioning

Slides 5–6

Which personas, pricing models, geographies and messages correlate with the highest revenue?

03

Customer Acquisition & Efficiency

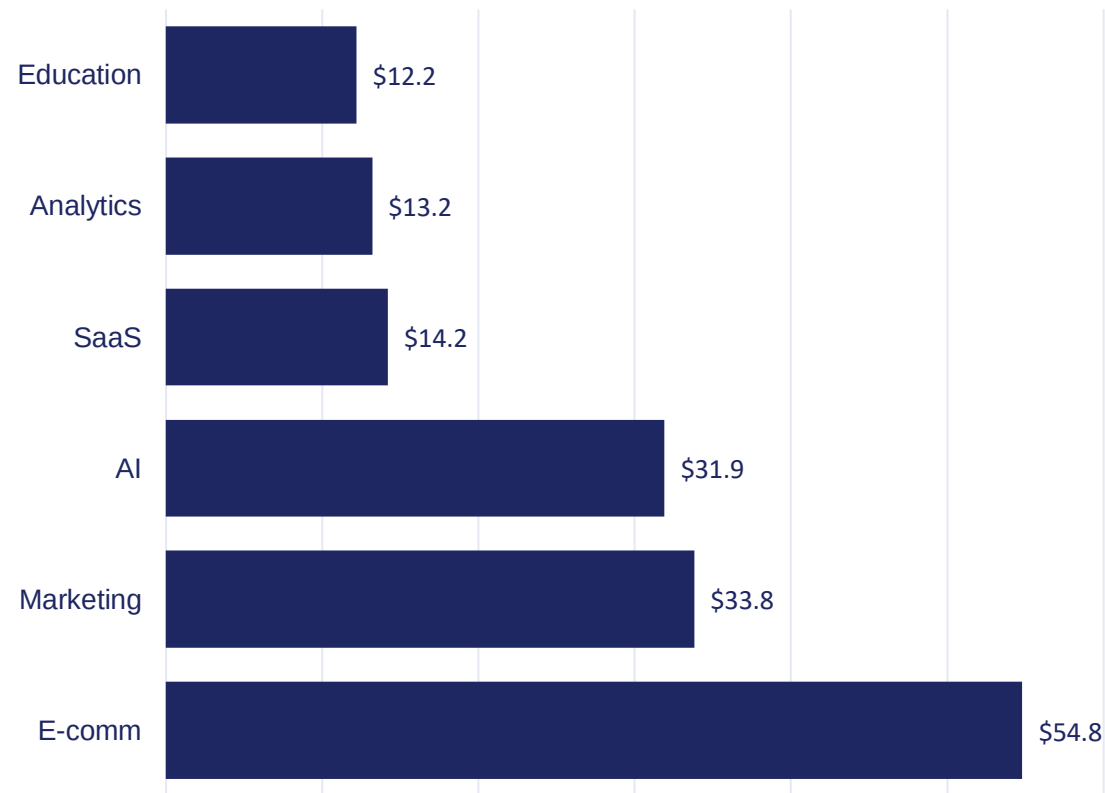
Slides 7–8

Does traffic or social following actually predict revenue — and who's quietly outperforming both?

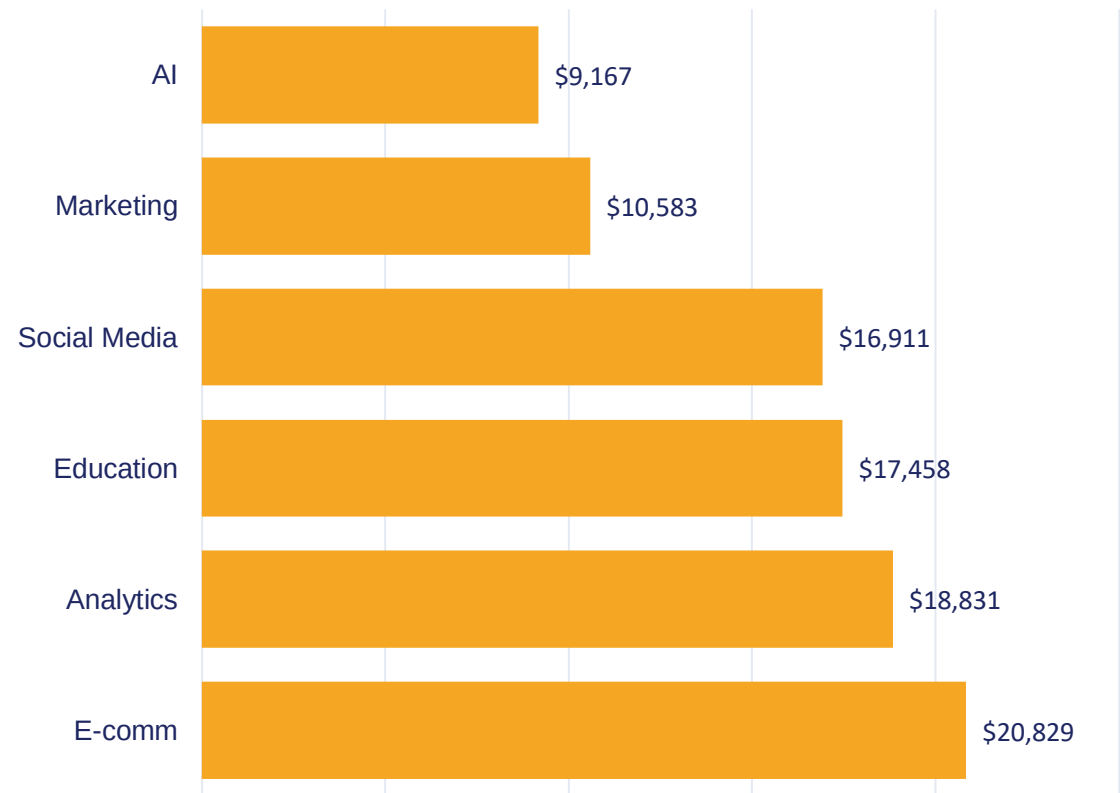
Closing slide: one clear takeaway per section, for a quick re-read whenever this needs revisiting.

E-Commerce Leads on Volume — and on Efficiency

Top Earning Categories (Total All-Time Revenue, \$M)



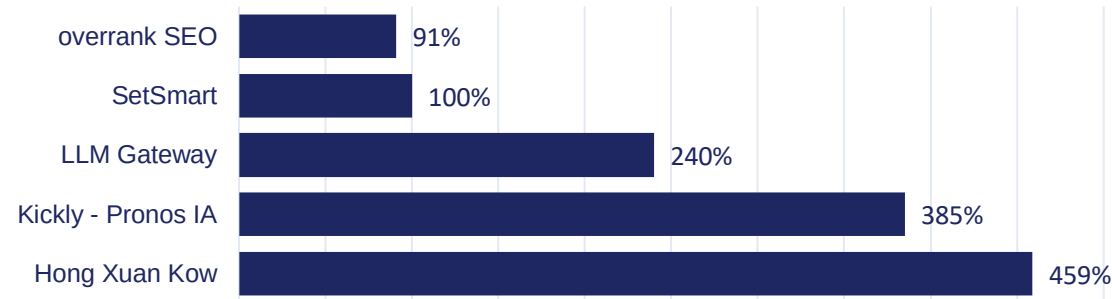
Average MRR by Category (\$, n≥10 startups)



KEY INSIGHT E-comm tops both charts — highest total revenue AND highest average MRR. AI has 197 startups (the most of any category) but ranks 6th on average MRR: scale, not efficiency, is driving its size.

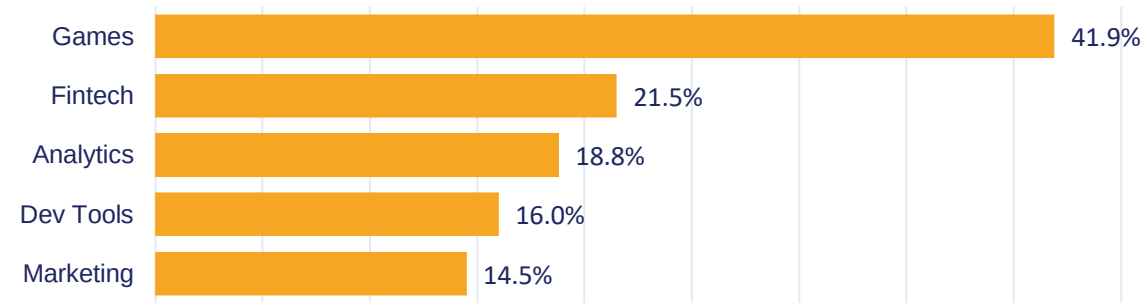
Revenue Is a Power Law — and Growth Is a Category Story

Fastest-Growing Startups (30-Day MRR Growth %)



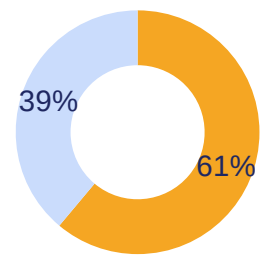
Off-chart for scale: a Stealth-labeled startup at +12,983% (real base: \$135.9K MRR) — uncategorized, so excluded from the category chart too.

MRR Growth % by Category (n≥10, outlier-trimmed avg)



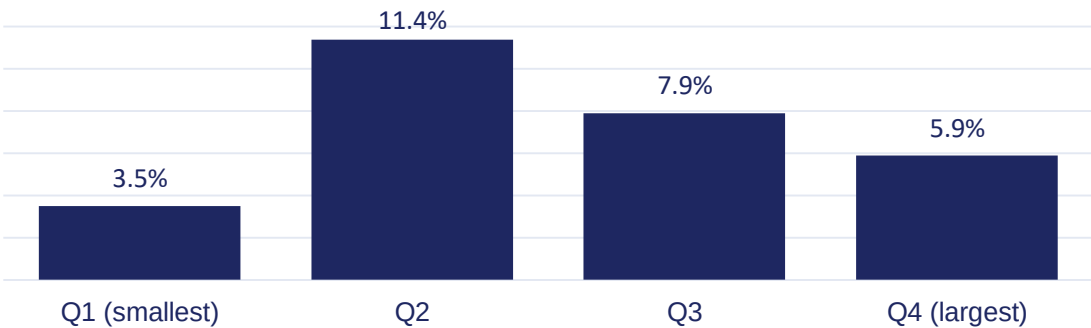
Raw (untrimmed) average misleadingly puts SaaS 1st at +64% — driven by one startup. After removing outliers, SaaS's real growth is +4.2%.

Revenue Concentration



61% of ALL revenue comes from just the top 10 of 1,000 startups.

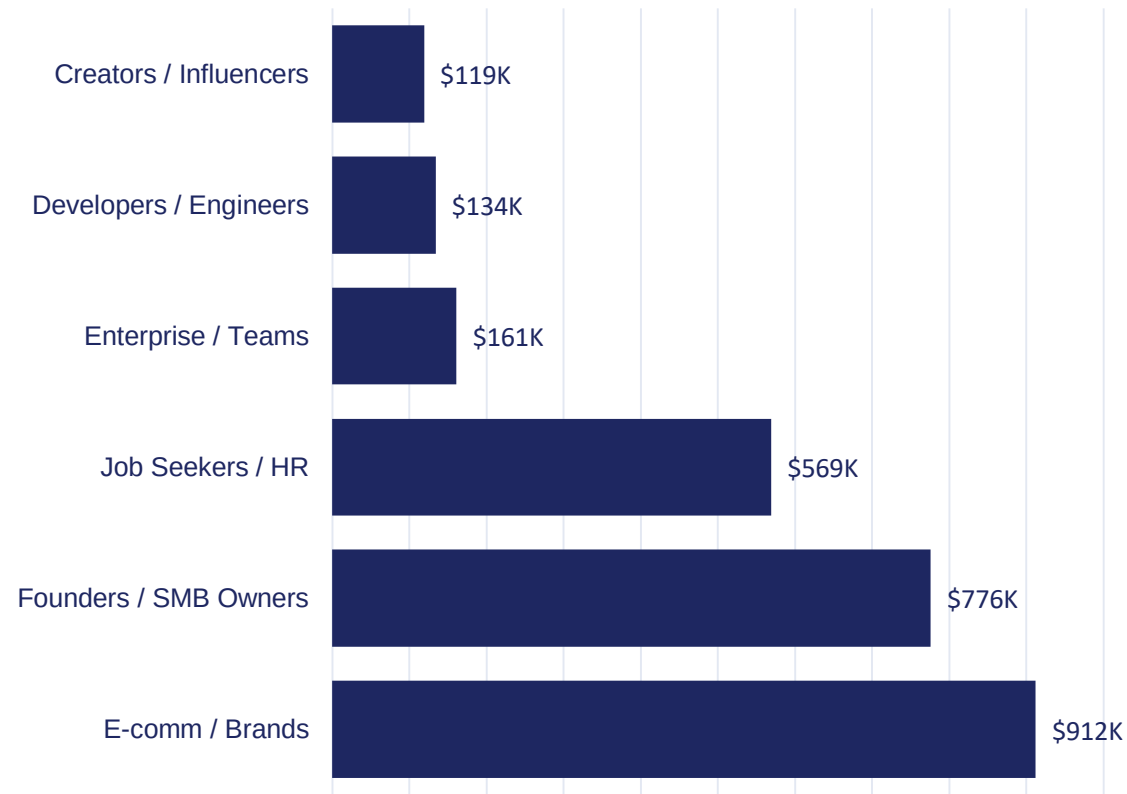
Growth Rate by Startup Size (Trimmed Avg %)



KEY INSIGHT 10 startups (1%) generate 61% of all revenue — a hard power law. Individual hyper-growth outliers don't signal category trends (the top mover isn't even categorized); at the category level, Games, Fintech and Analytics show real broad-based growth, while AI — the biggest category by count — sits mid-pack, reinforcing that its size is about crowding, not standout performance.

Founders and E-Comm Brands Pay the Most

Avg Revenue by Buyer Persona (\$K per startup)



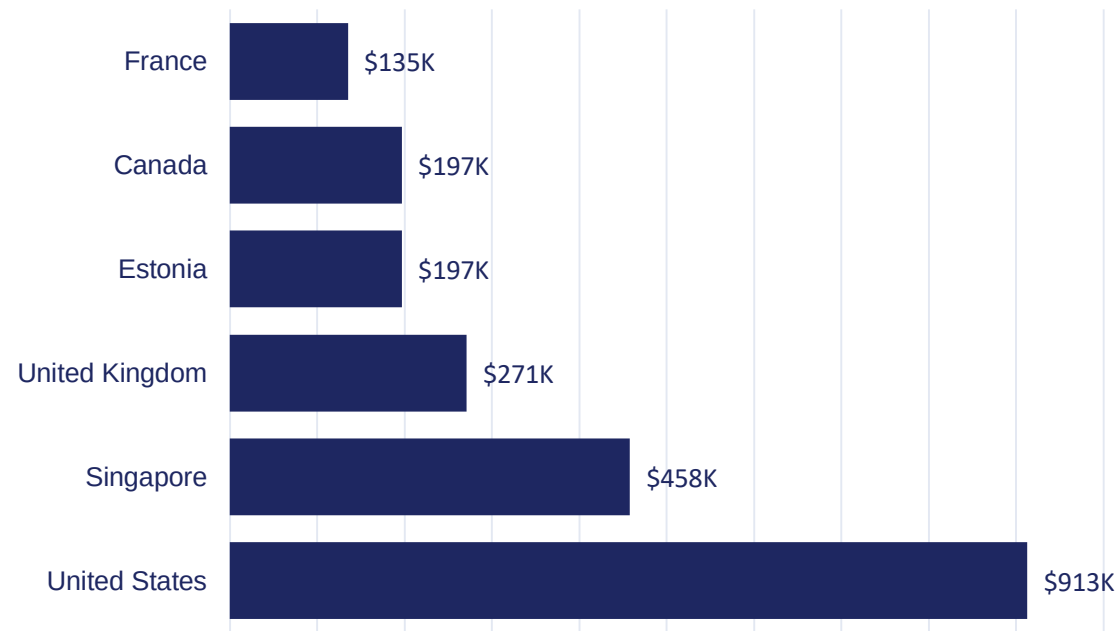
Median All-Time Revenue by Pricing Model (\$)



KEY INSIGHT E-comm brands and Founders/SMB owners are the highest-value personas by a wide margin. On pricing: usage-based and straight tiered-subscription models post 3-11x the median revenue of pure 'Freemium + Tiered' — giving away too much for free is measurably costing revenue.

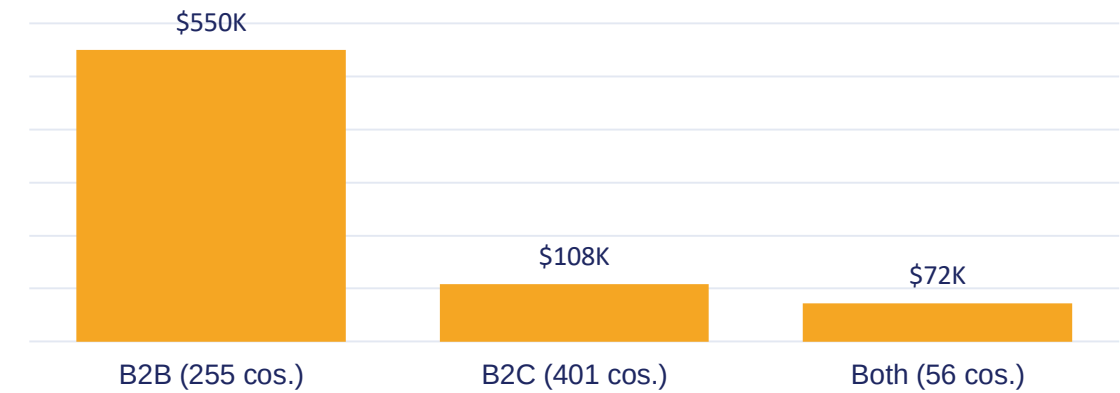
B2B Out-Earns B2C 5-to-1 Per Startup

Top Countries by Avg Revenue per Startup (\$K, min. 8 startups)

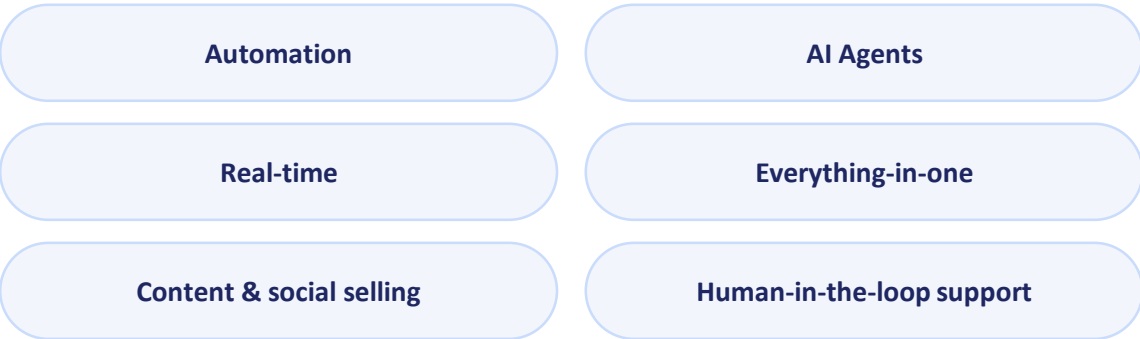


For contrast — India has the 2nd-most startups tracked (59) but the lowest avg revenue among major markets: **\$36.9K** avg, just \$98 median.

B2B vs. B2C — Avg Revenue per Startup (\$K)



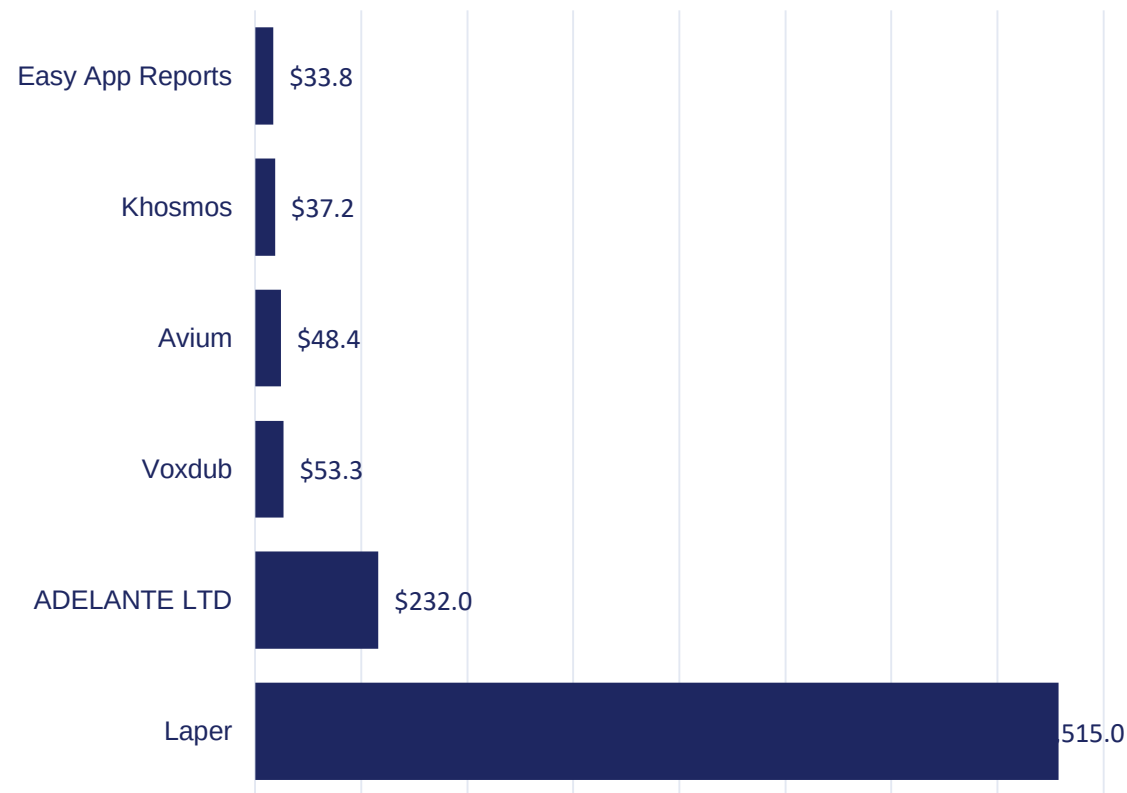
Common Themes in Top-60-Earner Value Propositions



KEY INSIGHT The US alone accounts for ~70% of all dataset revenue, and B2B startups earn 5x more per company than B2C despite far smaller followings — efficiency, not audience size, drives revenue. Winning positioning language centers on automation and AI agents.

Followers Barely Predict Revenue — Traffic Only Loosely Does

Highest Revenue-per-Visitor (\$, top 6 of 142 tracked)



Laper monetizes 6.5x higher per visitor than the #2 startup — a strong, tightly-targeted premium funnel rather than a broad one.

Do Traffic & Followers Actually Predict Revenue?

0.60

Traffic ↔ Revenue correlation (rank-based, n=178, 18% of dataset has tracked traffic).
Moderate — more visitors generally means more revenue, but far from deterministic.

0.23

X Followers ↔ Revenue correlation (rank-based, n=984, 98% of dataset). Weak — social following is close to noise as a revenue predictor.

KEY INSIGHT Traffic has a real but moderate relationship with revenue (0.60); follower count is nearly disconnected from it (0.23). Treat follower counts as a vanity metric, not a diligence signal or a media-spend justification.

Real Revenue Can Hide From a Traffic-Only Lens

1.3%

Median conversion efficiency (active subscriptions ÷ monthly visitors) across tracked startups — the baseline to judge any startup's funnel against.

"Underrated" — Low Traffic, High Revenue

Laper	16	\$24,042	40,035
Distribb	0	\$20,125	3,381
Khosmos	503	\$18,701	0
ReddGrow AI	497	\$13,055	219
ADELANTE LTD	52	\$12,057	0
Avium	219	\$10,600	335

"Overhyped" — High Traffic, Low Revenue

Conecta Fitness	39,308	\$506	721
StatsPanda.com	35,697	\$165	0
OpenInbox.io	25,076	\$401	1
Stealth Company	16,280	\$153	0
FewTap	12,621	\$72	386
StreamTrackr	10,162	\$666	55,104

KEY INSIGHT Several high-revenue startups (Distribb, Bookedin) show zero tracked web visitors — real distribution and revenue can sit entirely outside a traffic-based funnel. Meanwhile StreamTrackr's 55K followers translate to just \$666/month — don't let follower count anchor a valuation.

What This Dataset Means For Us

01

E-comm leads on both scale and efficiency; AI's size comes from crowding, not category-wide strength.

02

Revenue is a power law (top 10 = 61% of all revenue) — and small companies don't grow meaningfully faster than large ones.

03

Founders/SMB and E-comm buyers pay the most; pure-freemium pricing measurably underperforms tiered and usage-based models.

04

B2B out-earns B2C 5-to-1 per startup, despite smaller followings — efficiency beats audience size.

05

Traffic loosely predicts revenue; social following almost doesn't — stop treating followers as a diligence signal.

06

Some of the highest-revenue startups have near-zero tracked traffic — a traffic-only lens will miss real winners.